

## Mexico

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ICE >

# A Mexican migrant dies in ICE custody, bringing the total to 16 deaths this year.

Alejandro Cabrera Clemente, 49, had been detained since January and was found lifeless in his cell this Saturday.



Federal agents escort a man in Illinois, in an illustrative image.  
**JIM VONDRUSKA (REUTERS)**



### PAULINA FLORES RAMÍREZ

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The Trump administration's relentless crackdown [on migrants](#) has claimed another victim. U.S. authorities reported Monday the death of Alejandro Cabrera Clemente, a 49-year-old Mexican migrant who had been detained in early January. The number of Mexican deaths in the custody of Immigration and Customs Enforcement (ICE) has risen to 16 so far in 2026. According to a government statement, Cabrera was found unresponsive in his cell at the Winn Correctional Facility in Louisiana. Although he was transferred to a hospital for

In a statement, the Ministry of Foreign Affairs (SRE) emphasized that the cause of death "remains under investigation" and that it is in communication with U.S. authorities to learn the "circumstances prior" to Cabrera's death. The Mexican government stated that it activated the corresponding protocols and has already contacted the victim's family to offer assistance and legal support. "The actions to be taken in this case will be analyzed," the statement reads, in which the Ministry also expresses concern about the "serious deficiencies in detention centers" that violate human rights standards and the protection of life.

According to information provided by immigration authorities, Cabrera had been in the United States for more than 25 years and faced charges for drug possession and domestic violence. The Mexican national had been detained in Chattanooga, Tennessee (more than 900 kilometers east of where he was being held) and was awaiting deportation proceedings by the Executive Office for Immigration Review.

The alarming number of [migrants who have died in U.S. custody](#) has led the Mexican government to harden its stance and announce a series of measures beyond simply expressing its discontent through diplomatic channels. "We will be making more demands, not only what we have been doing, but now we will take further action in response to what happened," Claudia Sheinbaum stated two weeks ago during her morning press conference.

That same day, the Mexican Foreign Ministry (SRE) announced it [would bring the deaths of Mexican nationals before the Inter-American Commission on Human Rights](#) and that the government would participate in a class-action lawsuit against the Adelante Processing Center, a facility where four Mexicans have died so far this year. The Foreign Ministry stated that the deaths are not isolated incidents and "reveal systemic failures." At a press conference, Vanessa Calva, head of consular protection, expressed her concern about the subcontracting of private companies to operate the detention centers where the deaths have occurred. She also denounced the "complete lack" of communication between U.S. authorities and the families of the detainees.

teenagers in ICE custody exceeds 6,200, [a figure 10 times higher](#) than that recorded at the end of Joe Biden's term. According to the nonprofit news organization, an average of 226 children and teenagers have been arrested every day since the Republican took office for the second time. A report by Human Rights First on a family detention center in Dilley, Texas, denounced the abuses and cruelty with which these types of facilities operate, leading to due process violations and medical failures.

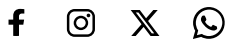
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